

Gopher Industries – Food Remedy API

SIT375 – Capstone Team Project (A)

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1. Summary

This report presents a comparative UX analysis of five leading food and health applications. Yuka, OneLabel, MyFitnessPal, FatSecret, and Fastic. The research aimed to identify common design patterns, unique feature implementations, and usability pain points across their product pages and core flows. Key findings indicate that color-coded health scores and barcode scanning are industry standards, while differentiation occurs through onboarding personalization (Fastic), alternative product suggestions (Yuka), and data density trade-offs (MyFitnessPal). Accessibility for color-blind users remains a gap across most apps.

2. Methodology

The analysis was conducted using the following UX research methods:

- Heuristic Evaluation: Assessment against Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics (e.g., Visibility of system status, Match between system and real world).
- Competitive Feature Analysis: Benchmarking of navigation structures, information architecture, and unique value propositions.
- User Feedback Synthesis: Review of community forms, app store comments, and social media discussions regarding recent updates.

3. App-by-App Analysis

a. Yuka (Food & Scanner)

Core Proposition: Instant health impact scoring via barcode scanning.

- Product page: Large circular color-coded score (red to green) with verdict text (“Excellent,” “poor”). Visuals: Relies heavily on Nutri-Score integration and visual badges.
- Common Patterns: Uses horizontal swiping for “Better Alternatives” recommendations.
- Unique features: Swipeable “better alternative” showing score deltas and ingredient overlap.
- Pain Points: History management is often cited as cluttered; users want bulk delete options. Categorization of favorites is lacking.

b. MyFitnessPal (Calorie Counter & Diet Tracker)

core Proposition: Comprehensive macro/micro nutrient tracking and database size.

- Product Page: Dense data table (recently shifted to tiled format, causing user backlash).
- Common Patterns: Uses a “Diary” metaphor (Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner)
- Unique Features: Largest food database; to robust recipe import features.
- Pain Points: New UI increases clicks (e.g., water logging from 1 to 3+ clicks); poor web responsiveness.

c. FatSecret (Calorie Counter)

Core Proposition: Simple calorie and macro tracking with a focus on community.

- Product page: Dated list view; high information density leads to mis-clicks.
- Common Patterns: Standard macro circles and food databases.
- Unique Features: Strong community recipe sharing.
- Pain point: “Add to Diary” flow requires too many screens; portion screen has duplicated nutrients causing hesitation.

d. Fastic (Intermittent fasting)

Core Proposition: Intermittent fasting timer and weight loss guidance.

- Product page: Gamified (starts, points) + friendly mascot + progress graphs.
- Unique Features: 60+ step visual onboarding (one question per screen, playful illustrations).
- Pain point: Lengthy onboarding may overwhelm impatient users, but data shows high conversion due to perceived personalization.

e. OneLabel (Ingredient Decoder)

Core Proposition: Deciphering complex ingredient lists (E-numbers, additives).

- Product page: Risk tires + allergen highlights; uses progressive disclosure (expandable tabs).
- Unique feature: Focus on chemical additives rather than macros or calories.
- Pain point: Smaller database compared to macro-focused competitors.

4. Comparative Analysis: UX Patterns & Flows

a. The “Scan → Decision” Flow

Feature	Yuka / OneLabel	MyFitnessPal / FatSecret
Primary Goal	Is this healthy? (Qualitative)	How many calories? (Quantitative)
Visual Hierarchy	High: Giant colored score + Verdict text.	Low: Numbers in a list. Requires math.
Cognitive Load	Low (App tells you if it's good/bad).	High (User calculates remaining budget).

b. The “Logging” Flow (Data Entry)

- Common Pattern: Search/Barcode > Select Serving Size > Confirm
- FatSecret Pain Point: The “Serving Size” selection screen historically suffered from information overload (duplicated nutrients), causing user hesitation.
- MyFitnessPal Pain Point: Recent updates buried the “Add Water” function behind an “Edit” button, increasing interaction cost from 1 click to 3+ clicks.

c. Alternative Recommendations (Unique to Yuka/TryVit)

- Pattern: While MFB focuses on “what you ate,” Yuka focuses on “what you should eat.”
- Visual Comparison: Emerging best practice uses side-by-side cards showing score delta (e.g., -23 points healthier) and ingredient overlap percentages.

5. Common UX Patterns Identified

- The “Hero” Score: Almost all health-centric apps place circular, colored numerical score at the very top of the product page.
- Nutri-Score Integration: Industry standard (A-E / Green-Red) is universally recognized and expected by users.

- Barcode Scanner Primacy: The camera icon is universally placed in the top right or center bottom navigation bar.
- Personalized Onboarding: Leading apps ask for weight, height, and goals immediately to “hook” the user

6. Unique Features Per App

App	Unique features	UX impact
Yuka	Swipeable “better alternative”	Empowers user choice; retains user in-app
OneLabel	Additive risk tiers	Addresses chemical additives, not just macros
MyFitnessPal	Massive crowd-sourced database	Accuracy standard, but UI eroding trust
FatSecret	Community recipe sharing	Strong social proof, through interface dated
Fastic	Long-form visual Onboarding (60+ steps)	Increase conversation via psychological commitment

7. Comparison notes

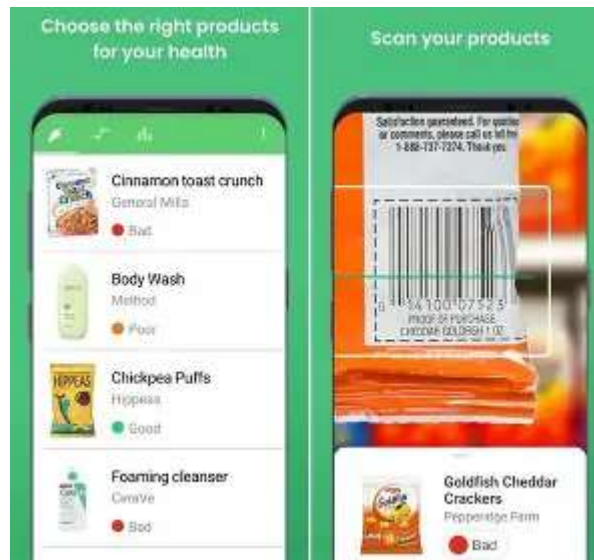
App	Strengths	Weaknesses
Yuka	Alternative feature; cosmetic scanning	History management: no bulk delete
OneLabel	Additive focus; progressive disclosure	Smaller database than competitors
MyFitnessPal	Largest database; recipe import	New UI increases clicks; poor web responsiveness
FatSecret	Community recipes	Dated interface; too many steps to log
Fastic	Engaging onboarding; gamification	Onboarding length may deter some users

8. Key takeaways

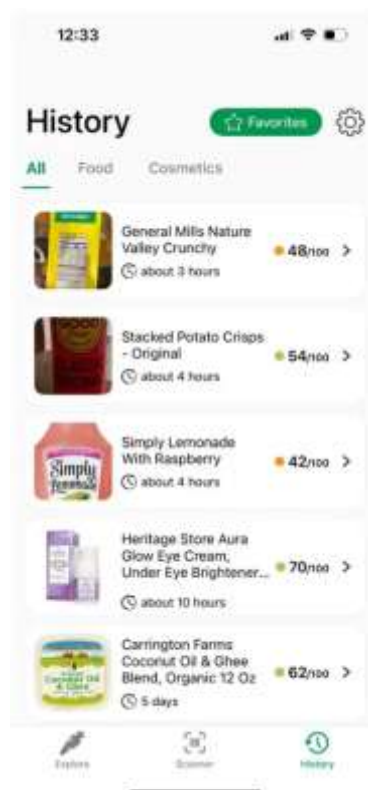
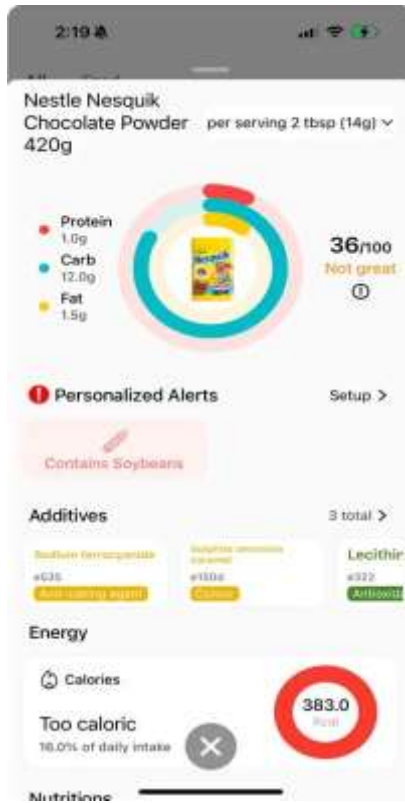
- Accessibility is non-negotiable. Color alone (red/green) excludes color-blind users. Designers must supplement with icons (thumbs up/down), text labels, or emojis.
- Don't sacrifice efficiency for aesthetics. MyFitnessPal's recent backlash proves power users prioritize speed and data density over visual whitespace and tiled interfaces.
- "Bad" is frustrating without alternatives. Simply telling users a product is unhealthy creates a dead-end. Yuka's swipeable healthier options convert frustration into action.
- Long onboarding works if it feels personal. Fastic proves 60+ steps succeed when segment visually (one question per screen), framed as a value exchange, and supported by a friendly mascot.
- Mobile-first ≠ web-hostile. Users switch to desktop for heavy logging (recipe entry, bulk edits). Web versions must not blindly mirror mobile touch targets.

9. Visual reference

- Yuka



- OneLabel



- MyFitnessPal



- FatSecret



- Fastic

Fastic Onboarding (still!) - the final screens in detail:

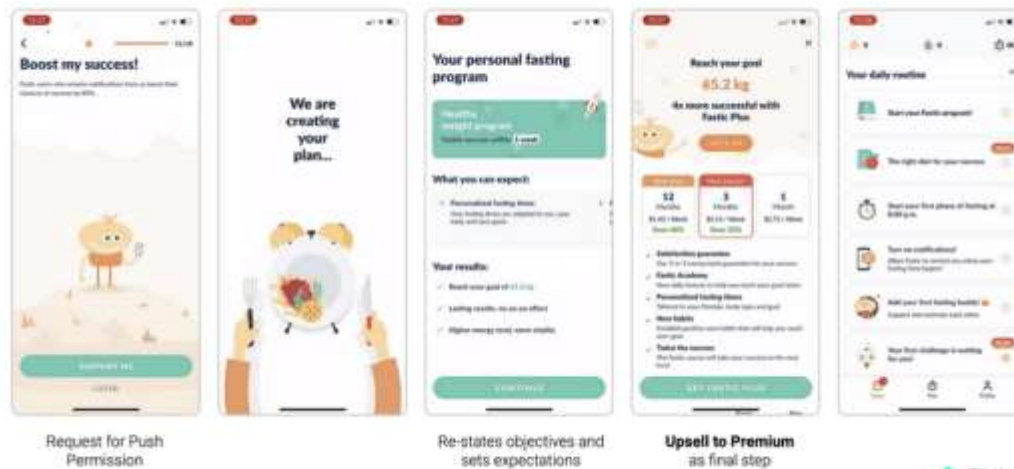
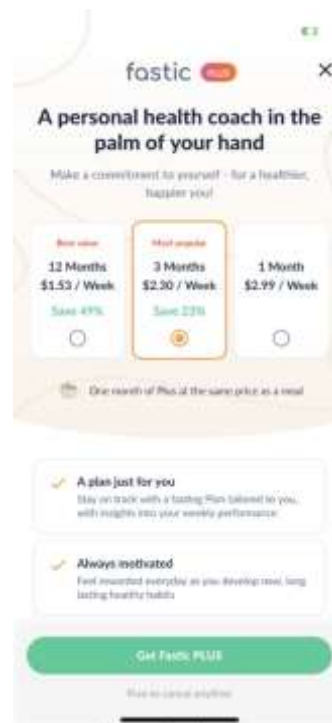


Image Credit: https://www.thesppful.com/examples/fastic_onboarding



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